MathsJam Shout

November 2025

MATHS WEEK ENGLAND

This month MathsJam lands in Maths Week England! 15-23 November, find out more at **mathsweekengland.co.uk**

Solve
Paired Squares

Take the numbers 1 to 16. Can you arrange them in a row such that each pair of adjacent numbers add up to a square number?

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9
10 11 12 13 14 15 16

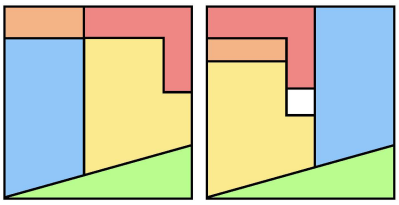
Explore
Maths Week England

MATHS WEEK ENGLAND

Visit **mathsweekengland.co.uk** for more resources including daily challenges and the chance to take part in a record-breaking Buffon's needle attempt!

Ponder
The Missing Square

Print and cut the five pieces from the PDF linked below. You can arrange them in either of these two ways... what is happening? Can you create a similar illusion with a bar of chocolate or scrap paper?



Printable PDF: mathsj.am/missing-sq

Write
Your own ♫♪ mathematical song

Write a song for the Maths Week England song challenge!

Here are three ways to get started:
- Pick the title or chorus of a song you love, and find mathematical words that sound similar. Write new lyrics based on those words.
- Choose a shape and an emotion. What would make that shape experience the emotion? Write that story.
- Think of a proof you know well and rewrite it in a way that fits a song structure.

Try using **wordhippo.com** to find rhymes and synonyms. There's no right or wrong – see where your creativity takes you!

Submit your entry: mathsj.am/mwe-songcomp

MathsJam Shout is a monthly sheet of ideas for activities to do at a MathsJam night. It's created using suggestions from a different MathsJam each month, and if you'd like to submit suggestions for a month in the future, email **katie@mathsjam.com** for details.

MathsJam is a monthly opportunity for like-minded self-confessed maths enthusiasts to get together in a pub and share stuff they like. Puzzles, games, problems, or just anything they think is cool or interesting. Monthly MathsJam nights happen in over 70 locations around the world, on the second-to-last Tuesday of each month. To find your nearest MathsJam, visit the website at **www.mathsjam.com**.